

wishpond EBOOK

**ST. PATRICK'S DAY:
THE COMPLETE
GUIDE TO SOCIAL
MEDIA MARKETING
FOR BUSINESSES**



wishpond.com

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WISHPOND SOCIAL MARKETING SUITE

... is the easiest way to run great marketing campaigns on every channel:



Facebook Pages



Twitter



Pinterest



Websites



Mobile



Local

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SOCIAL OFFER



PHOTO CONTEST



SWEEPSTAKES



VOTING
CONTEST



PHOTO CAPTION
CONTEST



PINTEREST
CONTEST



VIDEO
CONTEST



ESSAY
CONTEST

INTRODUCTION

WHY YOU SHOULD CARE ABOUT ST. PATRICK'S DAY?

St. Patrick's Day might be one of those holidays that you end up forgetting to market for or brushing aside. This should be reconsidered - Americans will spend upwards of \$4.5 billion this year. Although it may be the holiday that consumers spend the least on, it is still a substantial surge of spending to capitalize on.

Not enough businesses are taking advantage of the opportunities the holiday seasons bring via social media marketing. It's a time to create and grow your relationship with customers and clients online.

Money for St. Patrick's Day is spent on a variety of celebratory St. Patrick's Day themed merchandise - and of course the celebration itself. Are you a retailer, brand, restaurant, or pub?

If so, you have the opportunity to claim your chunk of that \$4.5 billion consumers are spending! So, how do you go about this? Read this ebook to find out.

Do St. Patrick's Day like the pros in social media marketing. In this ebook you will learn:

- How to get people to share your St. Patrick's Day content
- What Google+ can do for your business
- How to run St. Patrick's Day promotions
- The impact of photos on customer engagement
- Why to start early on the promotion of the occasion
- Strategies on using Facebook Ads to target demographics

CHAPTER 1

CONTENT MARKETING WITH SOCIAL MEDIA

Creating buzz around holidays and occasions takes more than just a post here and there. The use of various social networks will help you become more in sync with St. Patrick's Day and tie the hype of the holiday with your business.

Facebook

Posting about topics, holidays, and current events that Facebook users are already thinking about tend to go more viral than other posts. It's all about timing!

For example, posts that mentioned Independence Day on July 4th created somewhere near 90% more engagement than all other types of posts published that day.

What kind of content is best to post on Facebook?

- Photos on Facebook Pages receive 53% more likes than the average post.
- Photos attract 104% more comments than the average post.
- Fill-in-the-blank posts generate about 90% more engagement than the average text post.



Google+

Google+ is home to the tech-savvy. Which means outdated posts are not going to bode well with your audience. Relevant and trending topics are to be paid attention to. Keep track of when St. Patrick's Day is trending on Google+ so you can get on top of it at the best time.

The content shared by successful businesses such as Rogue Fitness always include images that appeal to their target market and the occasional links to tips, facts, promotions, and videos and relevant content. Posting links to your original content will get indexed by Google and improve your SEO.

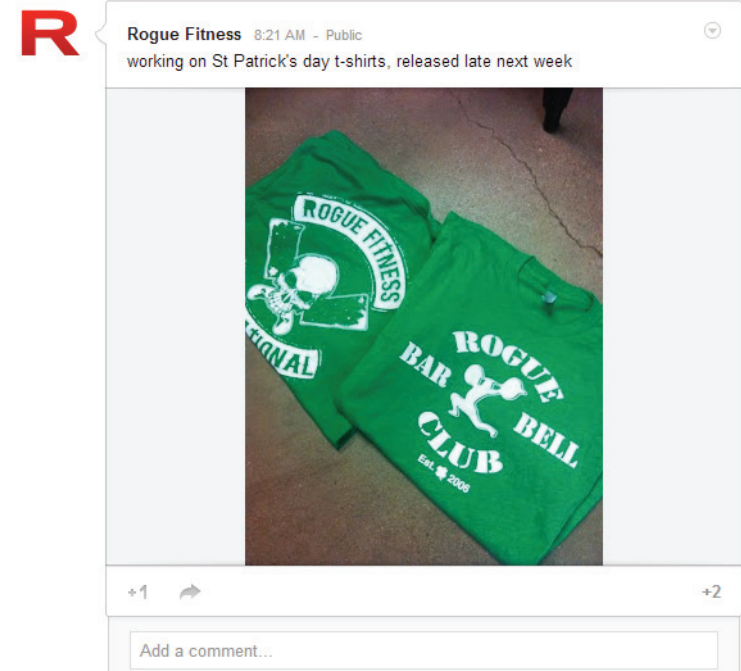
A significant part of Google+ that's often forgotten is the hashtag. Yes, the hashtag works on Twitter, Instagram, Pinterest and Google+.

It's key to understand their significance on Google+:

- Makes searching for topics easier
- Great way for users to stumble across your posts
- Combining your Circles strategy with hashtags will optimize your SEO not only on Google+, but Google search results as well

Pinterest

Pinterest is a powerful platform for interaction and purchase intent. Yet as of October 2012, 71% of businesses were not on Pinterest. Pinterest users spend more money, more often on more items than any other of the top 5 social platforms.

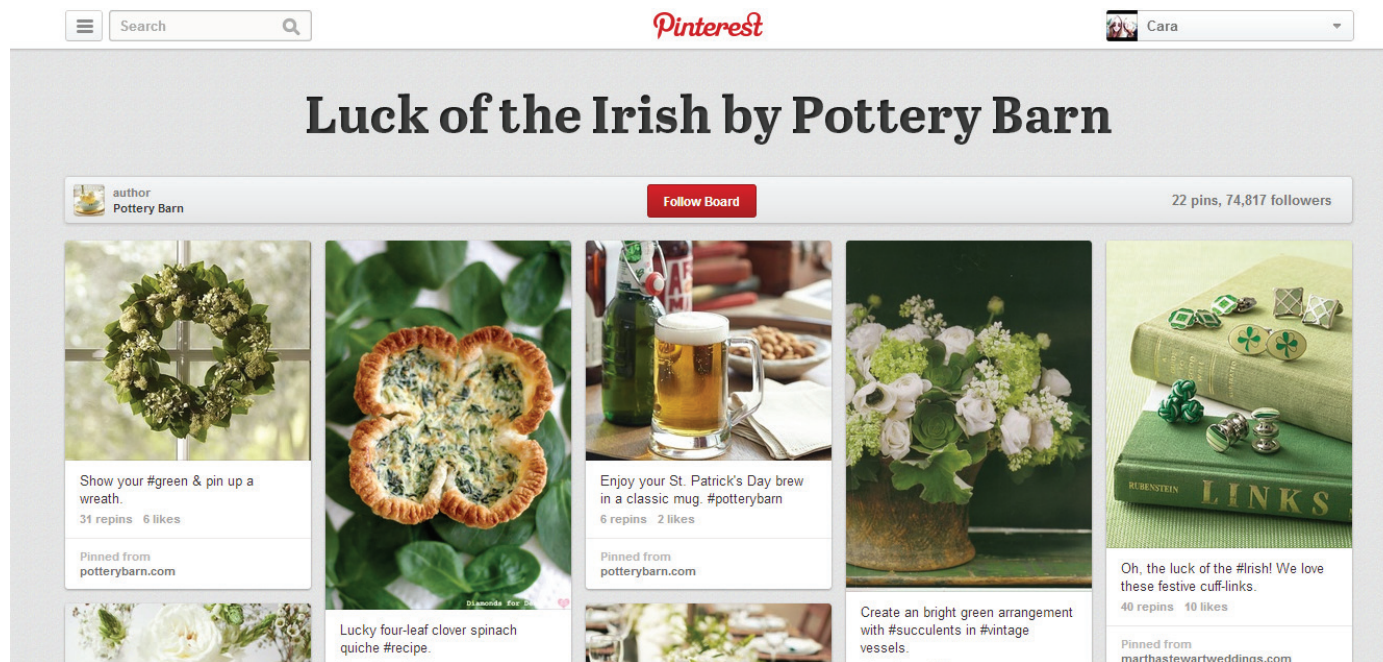


Sephora has reported that Pinterest followers buy 15 times more Sephora products per-capita than Facebook followers. That's huge!

This makes St. Patrick's Day the perfect time to utilize Pinterest. Consumers are on the hunt for those shamrocks, green t-shirts, leprechaun shot glasses, etc. Be the retailer to provide them with what they're looking for.

Employ these tactics on Pinterest:

- Show your followers how to incorporate your products
- Make a board dedicated to Saint Patrick's Day
- Don't just pin your products, pin photos that pertain to your business
- Solve any problems or questions you think they may have with tips

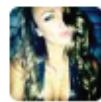


Twitter

It's hard to get heard with all of the noise on Twitter. There are approximately 3,000 tweets sent per second! So make your tweets exciting. In less than 140 characters, you have to grab the attention of your audience.

Giving followers a peek into behind-the-scenes can go a long way. To the audience, it feels exclusive. It's necessary to provide content that they feel is worth their time.

Seeing the word “photoshoot” associated with a picture automatically gives the viewer a feeling of exclusivity. Find words relative to your industry and St. Patrick's Day that makes your audience feel special.



Amber Nichole Miller @ufcambemichole

Feb 17

Today's photoshoot for [#StPatricksDay](#) [#XIV](#) [lopaynes](#)
[@arianasedilko](#) [mikey_tanha](#) [@sbe_nightlife...](#)
[instagr.am/p/V1M5VaqiXf/](#)

Followed by Michael Q Todd

[Expand](#)

Instagram

Instagram must be utilized correctly in order to get the message you want across to your followers. It can be a useful platform to feature general images, photography, contests, quotes and short messages.

Instagram profiles have been accessible online since November 2012. This makes your profile accessible to more people, and no longer available on just iPhones and Androids.

It's important to focus on not only your products, but also on other content your followers will find interesting. Make a balance between promoting your St. Patrick's Day merchandise and uploading pertinent phrases, images, etc.

Making use of hashtags is important on Instagram. Your businesses images will be found by more people, and you can even invent your own. Tag your St. Patricks Day posts with #stpatricksday or #stpattysday to attract people interested the occasion.

If relatable, use these other popular St. Patrick's Day hashtags:

- #shamrock
- #leprechaun
- #green
- #Ireland
- #Irish
- #clover
- #parade
- #stpattys
- #stpatrickspatrade
- #stpats



CHAPTER 2

SOCIAL MEDIA BRANDING FOR ST. PATRICK'S DAY

Incorporating St. Patrick's Day into your social media branding is simple. It's worth the time to show that you're ahead of the game.

Here's how you do it on Facebook and Twitter:

On Facebook, consider making a seasonal cover photo for the occasion. It will be more easily seen by visitors than a seasonal profile image for your business.

Urban outfitters features a fun design slightly incorporating their products for St. Patrick's Day. Even their profile image is lucky!



Another option is creating a St. Patrick's Day themed tab. Make sure it's visible on your Facebook page like Guinness has done this year.



On Twitter, you could do the same with your header image, background image or both! As you can see below, McDonald's went about both in subtle ways.



This is an example of a Walmart prompting users to submit St. Patrick's Day photos with the chance of being featured on their cover image.

When you have a significant fanbase, you will have fans willing to submit photos with the prize of being featured. You know how much that prize costs Walmart? Nothing.

This method is effective and they use the “featuring” as a prize quite regularly. Friends of fans will see that they’ve posted on Walmart’s wall, prompting them to take a look and possibly like the page.



Start ahead of time - you'll either be ahead of the crowd or head to head with the large brands and retailers. Posting St. Patrick's Day images 3 weeks before March 17th should distinguish your brand or retailer as a leader, not a follower.

CHAPTER 3

THE INFLUENCE OF ST. PATRICK'S DAY PASSION

A lot of excitement can be created around St. Patrick's Day if the effort is put in . Provide entertaining content that triggers readers to feel emotional engagement between themselves, your business, and the holiday. Play into the hype of the holiday - embrace the parades, leprechauns, pinching, four-leaf clovers, green beer, etc.

It's important not to stray too far from your industry while employing these ideas.

Many marketers believe that evoking emotion through content marketing is essential to make posts go viral.

In a study regarding the shareability of articles at the New York Times, it was discovered that:

- Awe was the second most viral type of content to be shared
- Conversational posts receive twice as many comments on average
- Posts filled with emotion are typically shared more

According to a study conducted by the University of Indiana, there are 6 primary emotions that humans have that you can tap into with your content.

1. Surprise
2. Joy
3. Sadness
4. Fear
5. Anger
6. Disgust

Especially for St. Patrick's Day, it is easier to stick to the second point - Joy. Anything celebratory or regarding luck is the most simple to play off of. If you're feeling creative, try a stab at one of the other six points.

Below, the pin is utilizing joy. People find joy in gift ideas for their loved ones.



LOVE! Mason jar St. Patricks Day treats! st-patricks-day

277 repins 46 likes



Repinned by
Misty Kearns - CEO of Me®



onto
St. Patricks Day Ideas - Recip...

Alright, you're still blank on how to relate your business to St. Patrick's Day? Have you thought about tapping into surprise in a negative way - even disgust? This move is not common, yet will provoke quite the reaction from your audience. You may even realize that more people hate St. Patrick's Day than you thought!

You may find that some people will react negatively to this, but this is a common risk with social media.

Topics that allow you to share an alike interest or opinion with your fans and followers bring on engaging conversations. For example, maybe Joe in accounting gets pinched every year by all of his colleagues regardless of whether he's wearing green or not. Therefore, he's developed a strong dislike for the holiday.

"What do you dislike most about St. Patrick's Day - the pinching or the crowded bars?" Get the conversation started on your Facebook Page.



If that seems too extreme and you feel that it won't go over well with your audience, there's always a lighter way to play around with St. Patrick's Day. Think of all the stereotypical St. Patrick's Day gear, accessories, and behavior. Find a way to poke fun at the holiday without going overboard, such as below. It would work perfectly for a funky yoga studio.



CHAPTER 4

HELP CUSTOMERS COME TO THE PURCHASE DECISION

People are going to listen to what you have to say if it's going to help them. Providing St. Patrick's Day ideas not only creates solutions for their needs, but helps your business create trust with consumers.

St. Patrick's Day related promotional posts with a solution don't seem as pushy as the regular ones without a purpose. It's more about suggesting as opposed to telling. The buyer will come to a natural "yes" and feel confident about purchasing the product.

It's essential to think about what your target market wants to see from you, and what kind of post they're going to enjoy most. What are their favorite aspects of your business?

Red Mango showcases a tasty St. Patrick's Day themed treat below. It's completely appropriate for the occasion, and doesn't force anything with the consumers. It's likely their audience will want to pop over after seeing the delicious display.



The Baddish Group suggests a helpful how-to video. They are effectively solving their customers needs on St. Patrick's Day.



The Baddish Group @thebaddishgroup

3 hrs

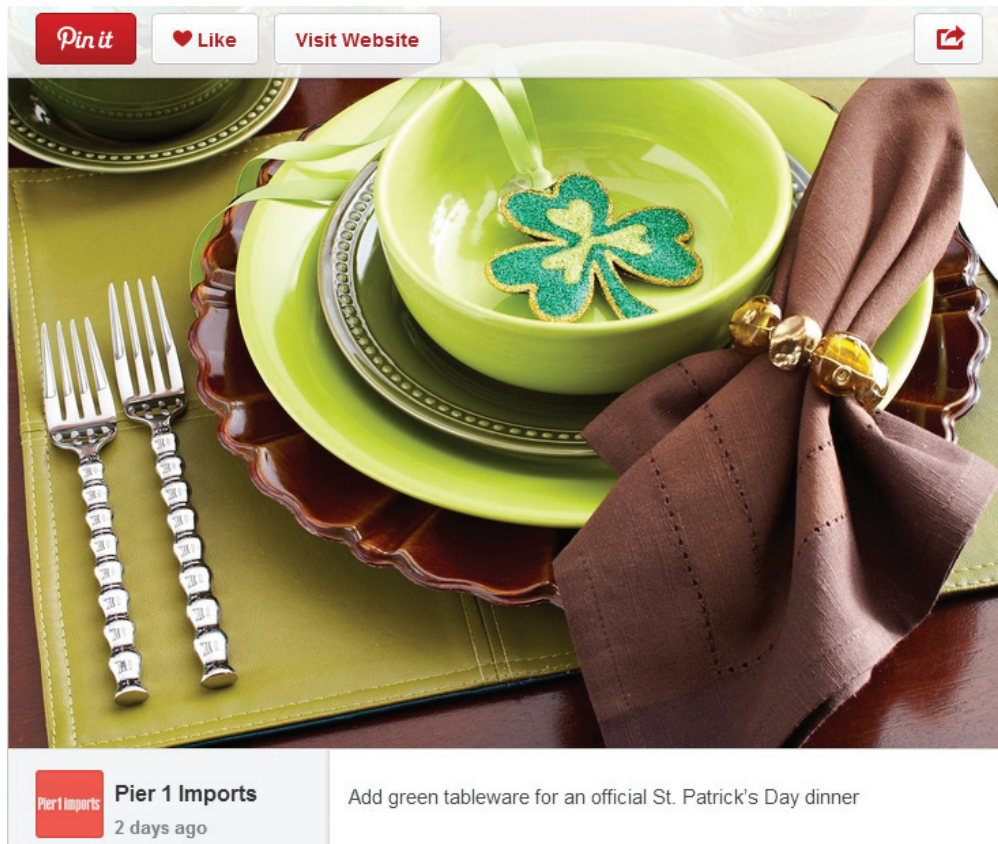
Check out this how-to [#video](#) on Irish coffee for [#StPatricksDay](#) with Concannon Irish Whiskey @theBuenaVista [ow.ly/i8Eok](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=i8Eok)

[View media](#)

Being specific about who the products/services are for grab the attention of your target market. People that are genuinely interested in your product are likely to click through.

If you don't feel any of your products/services are relatable to St. Patrick's Day, dig a little deeper. Businesses of all sorts find creative ways to market during all seasons.

Make a 'limited edition' product/service for St. Patrick's Day. Pier 1 simply dresses up a somewhat regular display with a colour story and a clover ornament.



Sometimes people need help coming to the conclusion that they need your products/ service. By suggesting timely promotions in a subtle way, you can cater to their needs and generate revenue for your business all at once.

CHAPTER 5

CONNECTING WITH CUSTOMERS AND CLIENTS

One of the important aspects of social media is communication between your business and your customers/clients. With a push in the right direction, people will feel more inclined to communicate with your business in social communities.

Make a connection between your business and the holiday. Incorporate your brand, product, or service without being promotional. These types of posts are more likely to become viral because fans feel it's for their entertainment value as opposed to your business's profit.



Give fans a reason to interact with your business.

What aspect(s) of your business do your fans love the most? What are their hobbies? Do your customers love low prices? What about quality customer service? Find a way to relate to their interests while incorporating the occasion.

Showing a connection between employees (or customers) and your brand.



Creating a mutual, genuine bond between the business and the consumers is essential for customer relationship management. If you want to keep them coming back, it's best to establish a relationship. Appreciating their input goes a long way.

Make your customers into brand advocates.

Who doesn't love free advertising?

Once you have established a relationship with your consumers, this step will fall into play. If they love your product, why wouldn't they Instagram it or put a picture of them wearing your shirt on Facebook?

Word-of-mouth (WOM) marketing is exactly what you should be striving for by sharing your unique products. Having your consumers sharing images or statuses about your product is extremely effective in spreading your businesses name.



Engage your audience without mentioning your products.

Generally on a holiday that your fans enjoy celebrating, they're in a good mood. Don't ruin their buzz by shoving your product at them. It is best to engage with them as opposed to selling to them on Facebook and other social platforms.

The goal isn't to send them running. Simply asking about their day, their plans, what they're excited about, what they're dreading, etc. will help you connect with them and they will maintain a positive attitude. Remember, it's all about them!



CHAPTER 6

PROMOTIONS AND CAMPAIGNS DURING ST. PATRICK'S DAY

Make online promotions that get fans involved. Take advantage of St. Patrick's Day and use contests to acquire more followers, likes, engagement, or whatever your goal may be.

Make sure your campaign/promotion is mobile compatible.

WHY?

- There are over 1.2 Billion people accessing the web from their mobiles
- 32% of people ages 18-24 use social networking in the bathroom. Yeah...
- 38% of smartphone owners use their device in front of the TV every day

Create your own hashtags to be used on either Twitter, Instagram, Pinterest or Google+. Making up your own hashtag can be fun and helps your brand go viral. If the hashtag goes over well enough, people will recognize the certain hashtag you create as yours.

You can also utilize generic hashtags applicable to your campaign such as #giveaway. These already have a defined virality, but are more generalized and apply to a lot more businesses.

Entice fans to comment on your posts by giving them an incentive, whether it be big or small. Comments, shares and likes all attribute to the increase in virality of your posts.



Varsity Tents is getting entrants to retweet their tweet so that the contest goes viral. People will retweet it if they are genuinely interested in the event, which is exactly what you want - advocates of your brand.



Offering seasonal deals is another way to make your fans on Facebook feel exclusive. If they miss the event, chances are they'll keep better tabs on your page if you run these types of promotions frequently.



Encouraging fans to play games that your business has created for the holiday is also a great way to get people interacting on your website and Facebook page. Creating hype around the holiday will in turn create hype around your business!



CHAPTER 7

TARGETING FACEBOOK ADS

Targeting Facebook Ads to a specific demographics is ideal if your promotion or campaign is directed at a specific audience. It is likely that you'll want to target most of your ads in one way or another.

There are many targeting options available:

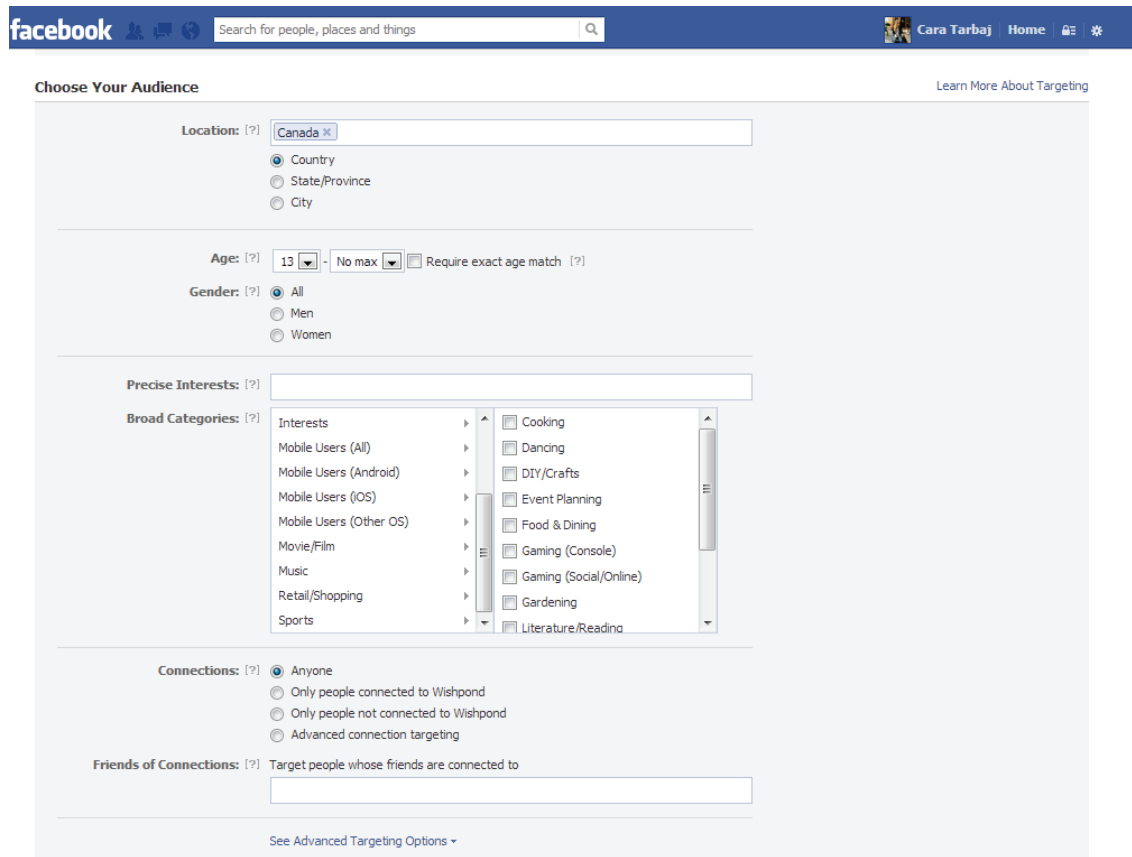
- gender
- relationship status
- age
- likes
- interests
- workplace
- education
- broad interests
- connections
- precise interests

Are you marketing clothing to young men on St. Patrick's Day? Well then there's really no point to targeting anyone with the "female" gender status on Facebook. It's likely you'll want to limit the age range as well. If you target a more specific audience, you are more likely to advertise to people who are more likely to be genuinely interested in the product or service.

There are two groups to target your ads to. You can target those users with the Precise Interests feature. In this field you can enter your competitors' names and target their Facebook fans. You can also target based on Broad Categories, including Marital Status, wider interests like "Food & Drink" and "Jazz/Blues" music.

Keep your audience to approximately 100,000 people - this is the optimal size of a group that you want to target.

- If you're over 100,000 fans: Limit the ages and geography to your most targeted groups and decrease the number of Precise Interests you have selected.
- If you're under 100,000 fans: Add more Precise Interests to target a larger number of users who have interests related to your business/industry.



The image shows the Facebook Audience Targeting interface. At the top is the Facebook header with the logo, search bar, and user profile (Cara Tarbaj). Below the header is the "Choose Your Audience" section. The interface includes several targeting options:

- Location:** A dropdown menu set to "Canada". Below it are radio buttons for "Country", "State/Province", and "City".
- Age:** A dropdown menu set to "13", with a "No max" dropdown and a "Require exact age match" checkbox.
- Gender:** Radio buttons for "All", "Men", and "Women".
- Precise Interests:** A text input field.
- Broad Categories:** A list of categories with expandable sub-lists:
 - Interests: Cooking, Dancing, DIY/Crafts, Event Planning, Food & Dining, Gaming (Console), Gaming (Social/Online), Gardening, Literature/Reading.
 - Mobile Users (All)
 - Mobile Users (Android)
 - Mobile Users (iOS)
 - Mobile Users (Other OS)
 - Movie/Film
 - Music
 - Retail/Shopping
 - Sports
- Connections:** Radio buttons for "Anyone", "Only people connected to Wishpond", "Only people not connected to Wishpond", and "Advanced connection targeting".
- Friends of Connections:** A text input field with the label "Target people whose friends are connected to".

At the bottom, there is a link "See Advanced Targeting Options".

APPENDIX A

SOURCES

Introduction:

<http://bit.ly/118XN39>

Chapter 1:

<http://blog.nielsen.com/nielsenwire/social/2012/>

<http://bit.ly/118XN39>

<http://blog.nielsen.com/nielsenwire/social/2012/>

Chapter 2:

https://www.facebook.com/business/fmc/guides/bestpractices?campaign_id=250393211715997&creative=best

<http://venturebeat.com/2013/02/27/sephora-our-pinterest-followers-spend-15x-more-than-our-facebook-followers/>

Chapter 3:

http://papers.ssrn.com/sol3/papers.cfm?abstract_id=1528077

Chapter 6:

<http://www.digby.com/mobile-statistics/>

Chapter 7:

<http://corp.wishpond.com/ebook/>

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